



TRACKING TECH IN INDIA

▶ **India is the undisputed IT leader of the world in 2023, but to maintain its lead in the sector, the country needs to invest massively**

▶ **To maintain its position, IT companies need to invest in evolving tech avenues like AI, ML, cloud, and cybersecurity**

▶ **IT enterprises' internal workings would also have to change with more focus on automation to improve efficiency and cut costs**

▶ **The rapid changes emerging in the sector would also require massive investments in skilling the workforce**

▶ **Industry watchers call for supportive government policies to ensure India remains a leading provider of IT services in the world**

the need for safeguards around individual and client data privacy all the more important. "IT companies will have to upgrade their tech stacks, leverage cloud and automate software delivery to really accelerate their development philosophy," he explains.

IT firms, it would appear, have already started working towards this realisation. "We have established our strategic focus around hybrid cloud and artificial intelligence, underpinned by very strong enterprise-grade security," says Sandip Patel, MD of IBM India/South Asia.

He adds that the ability to have applications and data work seamlessly across platforms is what the hybrid cloud is all about. "The ability to seamlessly have all that [applications and data] managed and do that with the right levels of efficiency so that you have faster speed-to-market is really what hybrid cloud is about. Next, doubling down on AI is equally important because the whole notion of being able to capture, curate and analyse the proliferation of data sets that are becoming real-time, and enabling them to help drive better decisions is vital for the growth of the sector," he adds.

For instance, the acquisitions by IBM—of Red Hat that provides hybrid cloud infrastructure among other things, and Instana that provides AI and automation services—highlight the sector's commitment towards these tech avenues.

REINVENTING BUSINESSES WITH TECH

Experts *BT* spoke to said IT firms would need to rethink their business models, keeping automation at the core of the operations for themselves as well as for their clients. "Business models will be re-architected by IT companies on a large scale; and business transformation programmes

will be tech-led," Bhatt says.

Automation and digitisation would make processes fast, efficient and reduce the cost for companies, which will in turn increase their revenues, says Srividya Kannan, Founder and Director of Bengaluru-headquartered Avaali Solutions, which provides digital solutions to enterprises. "By applying automation and digitisation solutions in certain cases, the process cycle time can be brought down by 35-50 per cent. Moreover, costs can be brought down by 10-15 per cent," she adds.

Rekha M. Menon, Chairperson and Senior MD of Accenture in India, echoes these views and highlights that IT companies in the coming 'Techade' would need to go through a "total enterprise reinvention that includes systematically reinventing every part of every business using tech, data and AI".

Industry watchers believe that IT companies would help move not just the digital transformation journey of their clients, but also India itself. They add that the government's focus on developing digital infrastructure to power public services and provide last-mile access to healthcare, education, financial- and agri-services speaks of the massive opportunity for collaboration available in the IT sector. "The India Stack with Aadhaar, UPI, CoWin, and the national health stack, have set a high benchmark for using technology to drive impact at scale. To live up to its potential in the 'Techade', the Indian tech industry must double down on existing priorities and create new ones," says Menon.

Bhatt adds that the IT sector will play a vital role in supporting critical infrastructure within the country. "Tech and IT firms will play a leading role in really enhancing public goods. It's not just about technology helping corporations become better